



ACHIEVEMENTS AND IMPACTS

2017-2018



FOREWORD

Capacity building, as has been said on so many occasions, is a long-term endeavor, one where success is achieved through patient investment in research and consistent effort. ECAS has, in its 3 years, 2016–2018, emerged as one of the Pan-African capacity building and research Think-Tanks. During this period, it has made significant and sustained investments in developing individual, organizational, and institutional capacities that have contributed to economic growth and sustainable development across various levels of governance.

ECAS has trained, supported evidence-based policy research, convened stakeholders and empowered public sector decision makers, business leaders, civil society organizations, individuals and community leaders with relevant skills and competencies, reflected in effective training and knowledge management programs. It has created and strengthened spaces and platforms for inclusive engagement and effective participation of non-state actors in environmental governance and business sustainability. Our success is the success of our benefactors—including its committed partners, collaborators, its competent and dedicated staff, and its governing organs.

This booklet is part of ECAS's effort to share best practices and knowledge of our interventions by highlighting success stories and showcases excerpts from our mission. It provides unique opportunities to reflect and consolidate our efforts and teamwork for greater successes in capacity development in Africa.

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INTRODUCTION AND BACKGROUND

Since its establishment in 2015, the Environmental Capacities and Technical Services (ECAS) Institute has emerged as one of the capacity development organizations in the region. It has catalyzed scalable change by investing in capacity building and research initiatives in the public and private sectors and civil society organizations. This has been achieved by implementing demand-driven projects and programs, providing tailor-made technical and advisory support to its partners, and generating, managing, and sharing knowledge on best practices in capacity building and sustainable development management.

The Institute has strengthened the capabilities of public and private sector institutions and created platforms for inclusive policy engagement. It has engaged senior public sector officials and managers who are leading national and county development processes. It has also engaged in and supported the generation and use of research-based evidence for decision-making and the enhancement of policy research capabilities of policy makers, practitioners and academia.

ECAS has also generated and disseminated research-based evidence to inform some of the strategic engagements in sustainable development and sustainable investments in Africa.

This booklet highlights ECAS's success stories over the past 3 years, detailing some of the key achievements and impacts of projects and programs we undertook.



OUR ACHIEVEMENTS AND IMPACTS

Although ECAS's work often begins with informing responses to environment and development challenges, the success of such initiatives ultimately depends on effective implementation through research and capacity building. With right capacity and research evidence, the rule of law can emerge, enabling a culture of compliance and environmental improvement. Through its work on research, programs and policies, public awareness on critical issues, and publications on key dimensions of environment, ECAS helps grow the effectiveness and resilience of key links in the development and sustainable development. Over the years, the Institute has been successful in pursuing its objectives and contributing to Africa's development. Described here are examples of the catalytic effect of ECAS's capacity building activities in six areas of support:

- Leveraging knowledge and learning to increase development effectiveness
- Facilitating open access to environmental information.
- Enabling effective delivery of sustainable development priorities.
- Working with governments to meet their sustainable development obligations
- Enhancing private sector and civil society contributions to achieve tangible sustainability results.
- Supporting efforts to ensure that environmental efforts protect and benefit the vulnerable.



GREEN GROWTH DIALOGUES

Four years since its formation, ECAS has become recognized for its contribution to environmental policy dialogue and as both a knowledge broker and also a source of knowledge. ECAS dialogues have already established their usefulness in influencing public discussion and policies as well as legislation. The overarching objective of the 3 dialogue sessions in the 2017-2018 period was to strengthen the planning and implementation capacities of players and actors for advancing green growth in Kenya.

The events were attended by target audience and participants including decision makers from National and County government and organizations representatives; private sector, including small and large scale enterprises; academia/ Science, research and technology specialists; CSOs and NGOs..

The dialogues were able to realize:

- Strategic alliances and partnerships to further address Kenyan actors' engagement in the context of climate action and sustainable development.
- A state and non-state actor engagement strategy to enhance effective green growth agenda integration into development processes.
- Enhanced knowledge on the status of public and private sector activities for sustainable development in Kenya.
- Increased awareness among actors of the necessity of multi-sector approach in the new development paradigm.



PARTNERSHIPS AND LINKAGES

ECAS managed to establish new and strengthen existing partnerships with actors across sectors and levels. In the 2017-2018 period, ECAS had strong working relations with the Pan African Climate Justice Alliance (PACJA) where we have been able to undertake joint events and activities as well as collaboration in capacity building and technical advisories.

Our second partnership was with the Hanns Seidel Foundation (HSF). We collaborated in a number of events and activities such as the development of Kenya Business Guide (KBG) as well as training on Campaigns.

We also had strong working partnership with the Frederic Ebert Stiftung (FES). For the last 4 years, FES has supported our activities and engaged ECAS in technical advisory roles. It is through their support that we held our first Green Growth dialogue.

The other partner we had opportunity to work with is the CARE International. Through their Ready-to-Work programme with Barclays Bank, we trained 30 fresh graduates on: Work Skills; People Skills; Money Skills; Entrepreneurial Skills.

Lastly, most of our trainings, research and capacity building events were hosted at the Institute for Climate Change and Adaptation (ICCA) at the University of Nairobi. This is due to a collaboration and partnership agreement we have had for the last 4 years.

Moving forward, ECAS will endeavour to enter into new partnership arrangements even as we strengthen existing ones.



TECHNICAL ADVISORY AND SUPPORT

While ECAS delivers specific expertise within each of the program areas, the objective of the programme is to support development actors in the domains of business, advocacy, policy development, , research, institutional strengthening and development strategies. ECAS has advanced the concept of Inclusive Green Economy across sectors with more than 10 partners in supporting their transition to a green economy. We customize our advisories to particular need within economic, social and environmental dimensions. The integration cuts through national, sectoral development agendas and helps strengthen policy coherence and policy cost-effectiveness.

In the 2017-2018 period, ECAS was engaged in several advisory roles including:

- The Climate Change and Development(CCDA) Conference in Nairobi- Rapporteur services as well as developing position papers.
- We worked with Migori County Government where we supported them in developing climate change policy framework.
- We were engaged by Samuel Hall in a Market Systems Analysis project in Dadaab, with focus on Recycle/Waste Value Chain.
- Facilitated 5-day multi-stakeholder training workshop on the use of UNEP developed Toolbox to support Kenya's transition to a green economy.
- The Kenyan Non-Governmental Stakeholder Consultative Workshop on Preparation for the 2017 Session of the UNEA
- Mini Stakeholders' Consultative Conference on TICAD



TRAININGS AND SKILLS DEVELOPMENT

To address climate change and related disaster challenges in Sub-Saharan, ECAS planned and executed several workshops and seminars. Some were internal and others were done in collaboration with partners. Upon completion of the course, participants are equipped to undertake necessary activities to strengthen climate change response and be sufficiently aware and knowledgeable to generate support for these actions within their agencies and networks.

The trainings are conducted using a range of interactive teaching methods including lectures, participatory discussions, and case studies among others. Participants are encouraged to share their own experience of developing responses to complex environmental challenges – including climate change – in their area. The courses also included field visits organized in association with our partners and collaborators.

Some of the trainings we undertook in the 2017-2018 period include:

- Training Workshop on Climate Governance for Kenya CSOs Platform on Climate Governance funded by PACJA.
- National Green Economy Workshop on Replication and Sustainability of Green Economy Planning in Kenya
- Training on Regional Climate Change Policy Landscape and Impacts on future Sustainable Development Prospects
- Introduction to Sustainable Project Management
- Report Writing Seminar



MENTORSHIP AND SKILLS DEVELOPMENT

Our mentorship and skills development programme seeks to expose university students and young graduates to practical and innovative employability skills and opportunities that come with climate change and sustainable development.

The programme provides young people with the opportunity to develop the core competencies and skills required for transition from campus to the real world of work and self-employment. We aim to: with particular focus on the following competencies:

- Match classroom and practical training through apprenticeships, internships, job placements, projects on the job etc.
- Promote special measures that can speed self/employment-centered green transformations
- Complement trainings currently available so that they meet the skills needs required by employers.
- Help jobseekers meet the requirements of the numerous jobs which are currently on offer but cannot be taken up due to lack of skills.
- Compliment entrepreneurship trainings and business coaching for young people to start up green businesses in conjunction with government support.
- Build capacity of young people to strengthen their social dialogue mechanisms and to apply these to dialogue about accessibility and retainability of green jobs.
- Contribute to formal education and training systems and institutions in provision of basic skills for all and to raise the skills base of the national workforce; this includes improving apprenticeship systems and building synergies with NGOs and private sector employers

Participants in this programme have the opportunity to intern/be employed at ECAS or recommend them to our partner and employers. Certificates are issued on successful completion of the programme. We have so far trained 70 fresh graduates and senior university students.



KNOWLEDGE SERVICES AND AWARENESS

The ECAS Institute continues to be a reputable source of environmental knowledge. Our experts are increasingly being called upon to further discuss the subject in media especially television. The press regularly uses publications and contents of presentations at our popular dialogues for environmental analysis. Our activities and products are useful reference guides.

We have been using our networks and platforms to inform the public, policy makers and practitioners of alternative strategies. Feedback left on the Website and social media platforms inform us that those who have been in contact with our work find it invaluable and useful for proactive engagement in development and investment decision making.

The ECAS's Environmental Agenda Series is intended to provide a comprehensive "State of the Nation" report of environmental issues.

Some of the activities we undertook in partnership and in collaboration with other partners and actors include:

- Rise for Climate Conference
- Pre-COP24 National Stakeholders Conference
- National Climate Governance Conference
- National Level Workshop on Integrating Ecosystem Based Adaptation into National Policies and Plans
- Makueni County Climate Change Forum
- Seminar on Climate Finance



POLICY RESEARCH AND ANALYSIS

The Research programme seeks to bridge the gap between research- policy-practices. We focus on specific themes and methodological issues such as assessments, and sustainability across such sectors as waste, energy, water, food security, manufacturing and infrastructure. The programme has opened up opportunities for direct communication and relation with research institutions, businesses, universities and media as they touch on areas of interest to them. The programme has been quite successful in this regard and we shall seek to deepen our work with these actors through a structured relationship and assist in building up the required analytical capacity to ensure that research continues to inform development policies and strategies.

Some of the research activities we have undertaken and collaborated in the 2017-2018 period include:

- Operationalizing Green Economy Transition in Africa: Status of Green Economy initiatives in Nakuru and Mombasa Counties
- Development Corridors Partnership (DCP) Project
- Knowledge Systems Innovation Policy Landscape In Kenya
- Re-Packing Indigenous Knowledge to Inform Policy, Development and Pastoral Community Actions in Kenya
- Adaptation at Scale in Semi Arid Regions (ASSAR)

BLUE ECONOMY CONFERENCE

ECAS team was represented during the Inaugural Blue Economy Conference. The Conference was a preparatory to the 2020 Ocean's Conference which Kenya will be co-hosting with Portugal. The goal of the Global Blue Economy Conference is to have action-oriented discussions pertaining to a sustainable blue economy strategy that is people-centric, with ocean-centric investments. The Conference provided an opportunity for both developing and developed countries to explore among others, the priorities and challenges of establishing a sustainable blue economy and its contributions to the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development including maritime safety and security. It also sought to highlight the innovative role of various stakeholders, including national and local governments, private sector, civil society, regional and sub-regional groups.

Our focus in the conference was the Science and Research Symposium which was envisaged to produce recommendations for:

- Creating new partnerships and networking opportunities for scientists, scholars/promote sector initiations and public participation
- Establishing a Blue Economy research and technology fund
- Strengthening research technology, capacity and innovation in all sectors of the Blue Economy.
- Research areas and options within the Blue Economy agenda
- Forming Blue Economy research and innovation networks for Africa and the global south.



CLIMATE GOVERNANCE

ECAS engaged in climate governance activities with the main goal of the improving climate governance in Kenya with the targets being leadership, good governance, and policy advocacy. We sought to fill capacity gaps in terms of understanding on climate governance, adaptation, mitigation, finance, technology and the roles of different actors in climate change response. We achieved this through periodic training for the various platforms, networks and working groups as well as other relevant platforms. Some of our achievements in this regard include:

- Training and taking leadership roles in the Kenya Climate Change CSO governance platform.
- Taking part in the discussions to establish Climate Risk Insurance network
- Taking part in the development of the National Climate Change Action Plan (2018-2022)
- Participation in the discussions to develop Public Finance Management (Climate Change Fund) Regulations, 2018
- Offering technical advisory services during the National UNFCCC- Pre- and Post-COP24 Stakeholder Workshops
- Co-hosting a seminar on Integrated Planning for Climate Change and Air Pollution Mitigation in Kenya: Towards Vision 2030 and the Paris Agreement
- Co-planning Workshop on Knowledge Mapping on Climate Risk and Risk Response Strategy through the Lens of Pastoral Systems



CONCLUSION

The stories in this booklet show how central capacity development is to Africa's transformation and sustainable development agenda. They attest the role and continuing relevance of ECAS in supporting scalable change by promoting the embrace of the research-policy and practice nexus through capacity strengthening and improving the quality, processes, implementation, monitoring, and evaluation of public and private development policies and programs.

There are still challenges associated with inadequate capacity and limited policy based research for effective implementation and achievement of the sustainable development priorities.

State and non-state actors need capacities — human, institutional and soft — to enable them to achieve results and address sustainable development challenges.

This booklet clearly shows that, with adequate resources, ECAS Institute will be able to do more in supporting the global objective of achieving inclusive and sustainable growth. More important, ECAS's 3 years of experience in developing capacity shows the need to craft strategies that will stimulate the development, use, and retention of relevant capacities and strengthen partnerships among all stakeholders.

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